

150-C2-5119
Prepare an Operation Order
Status: Approved

Security Classification: U - Unclassified

Distribution Restriction: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Destruction Notice: None

Foreign Disclosure: FD1 - This training product has been reviewed by the training developers in coordination with the Fort Leavenworth, Kansas, foreign disclosure officer. This training product can be used to instruct international military students from all approved countries without restrictions.

Conditions: The staff officer receives an order from higher headquarters (HHQ) or the commander derives a mission requiring the staff officer to prepare an operation order. The commander issues guidance on preparing an operation order in a dynamic and complex operational environment (OE) throughout operations to shape, counter aggression, and prevail in large-scale combat operations (LSCO); consolidate gains; and achieve mission objectives. Regular, irregular, criminal, and/or terrorist threats contest the unit's objectives in all five domains (air, land, sea, space, and cyberspace). Additionally, they maintain the ability to sustain all nine forms of contact (direct, indirect; non-hostile; obstacles; chemical, biological, radiological, and nuclear [CBRN]; aerial; visual; electromagnetic; and influence) with the unit. All eight operational variables of PMESII-PT are present and dynamic for brigade and above; four or more variables are present for battalion and below. The order from higher headquarters includes all applicable overlays and or graphics, area of operation (AO) boundaries, control measures, and criteria for subsequent tactical actions. The staff officer has communications with subordinate units, adjacent units, and higher headquarters. The order from higher headquarters includes all applicable overlays and or graphics, area of operations (AO) boundaries, control measures, and criteria for subsequent tactical actions. The staff officer has communications with subordinate units, adjacent units, and higher headquarters. The commander has organized the four components of the command and control system to support decision making, facilitate communication, and conduct operations.

Note: Conduct the task using Secret/Releasable (S/REL) classified mission partner network (MPN) to enable C2, decision making, shared understanding with mission partners (collaboration and the display and sharing of relevant information), which realistically portrays a mission partner environment (MPE). The Army will likely conduct operations on an MPN, within an MPE in a combined theater. Produce orders, estimates, and other staff products on the MPN, using the secret internet protocol router (SIPR) not releasable to foreign nationals (NOFORN) by exception

Environment: Some iterations of this task should be performed with degraded command and control networks, degraded conditions in the electromagnetic spectrum, and/or degraded, denied, and disrupted space operations environment (D3SOE). Also, enemies and/or adversaries have taken actions to create anti-access or area-denial (A2/AD) conditions. This task should not be trained in MOPP 4.

Standards: The staff officer prepares an operation order (OPORD) by analyzing information from the military decision-making process (MDMP), running estimates, and the operational environment (OE) to provide the commander and subordinate units all information needed to achieve mission success. The staff officer prepares a clear and concise five-paragraph OPORD in accordance with the commander's guidance, the approved course of action (COA), and the unit's standard operating procedures (SOP). The order institutes control measures necessary to integrate and synchronize the operation while allowing subordinates to exercise disciplined initiative within the commander's intent. The staff officer prepares an OPORD in accordance with (IAW) FM 5-0, established timelines, the commander's intent, the Army Ethic, and SOP, while adhering to the GO / NO-GO criteria without error.

Special Conditions: None

Safety Risk: Low

MOPP 4: Never

Task Statements

Cue: The staff officer receives an order from higher headquarters or the commander derives a mission that requires the staff officer to prepare an operations order.

DANGER

Leaders have an inherent responsibility to conduct risk management to ensure the safety of all Soldiers and promote mission accomplishment.

WARNING

Risk management is the Army's primary decision-making process to identify hazards, reduce risk, and prevent both accidental and tactical loss. All Soldiers have the responsibility to learn and understand the risks associated with this task.

CAUTION

Identifying hazards and controlling risks across the full spectrum of Army functions, operations, and activities is the responsibility of all Soldiers.

Remarks: For questions, concerns, or comments, please contact: usarmy.leavenworth.tradoc.list.mission-command-coe-dot-ted@army.mil

Notes: The term "staff officer" refers to any individual member of a staff section (officer, warrant officer, or noncommissioned officer) that is responsible for conducting the task action or generating the product required by the task in the absence of the principal staff officer.

Performance Steps

1. The staff officer prepares an operation order (OPORD) that is clear and concise with the required supporting information (using the Army's OPORD format) from a selected course of action (COA).

- The COA statement becomes the concept of operations for the plan.
- The COA sketch becomes the basis for the operation overlay.
- Planners use their knowledge, experience, skills, and judgment to fill in missing details for any part of the operation not analyzed during the military decision-making process (MDMP) COA analysis.

2. The staff officer includes administrative information when preparing the OPORD.

Note: Refer to FM 5-0, Figure D-2 for the format and instructions for developing the OPORD.

a. Places the classification at the top and bottom of every page of the OPORD and in front of each paragraph and subparagraph in parentheses.

b. Places the formatted heading information of the OPORD.

- Identifies the copy number and the total number copies (e.g., copy 1 of 5 copies).
- Identifies the official designation of the issuing headquarters.
- Identifies the place of issue.
 - Code name.
 - Postal designation.
 - Geographic location.
- Identifies the date-time group of the signature.

Note: The date or date-time group is when the order was signed or issued and becomes effective unless specified otherwise in the coordinating instructions.

c. Identifies the OPORD [number, code name (if any), classification of title] consecutively by calendar year.

d. Identifies pages.

- Identifies pages following the first page of the order with a short title identification heading.
- Identifies the number (or letter) designation of the order and the issuing headquarters.

e. Identifies references. List documents/references essential to understanding the OPORD (list references concerning a specific function in the appropriate attachment).

(1) Maps.

- Lists maps and charts first.
- Map entries include series number, country, sheet names or numbers, edition, and scale.

(2) Lists other references in subparagraphs.

f. Identifies the time zone used throughout the OPORD.

- States the time zone used in the assigned area during execution.
- States when the OPORD applies to units in different time zones, uses Greenwich mean time (ZULU).

g. Describes the task organization.

- Describes the organization of forces (including attachments and detachments available to and from the issuing headquarters) and their command and support relationships.
- Communicates when each attachment or detachment is effective (e.g., on order, on commitment of the reserve).
- Directs to refer to Annex A (Task Organization) for long or complicated task organization.

3. The staff officer prepares Paragraph 1 - Situation, which describes the conditions of the operational environment (OE) that impact operations.

a. Area of interest (AI). Describes the AI, which includes the area of influence (e.g., in all five domains and information aspects). Refers to Annex B (Intelligence), as required.

b. Assigned area. Describes the assigned area. Refer to the appropriate map by its subparagraph under references (e.g., "Map, reference (a).\" See Appendix 2 (Operation Overlay) to Annex C (Operations) as required.

- Terrain. Describes the aspects of terrain that impact operations, refers to Annex B (Intelligence) as required.
- Weather. Describes the aspects of weather that impact operations, refers to Annex B (Intelligence) as required.

c. Enemy forces.

(1) Identifies enemy forces and appraises their general capabilities.

(2) Describes the enemy's:

- Composition.
- Disposition.
- Location.
- Strength.
- Probable COAs.

- (3) Identifies enemy informational considerations as required.
 - (4) Identifies any adversaries within the assigned area; refers to annex B (Intelligence) as required.
 - (5) Identifies enemy informational considerations as required.
 - (6) Identifies any adversaries within the assigned area; refers to Annex B (Intelligence) as required.
- d. Friendly forces. Identifies the missions of friendly forces in the following subparagraphs.
- (1) Higher headquarters two levels up. Identifies the higher headquarters mission and commander's intent two echelons above.
 - (2) Higher headquarters one level up. Identifies the higher headquarters mission, commander's intent, and concept of operations one echelon above.
 - (3) Missions of adjacent units. Identifies and state the missions of adjacent units and other units whose actions have a significant impact on the issuing headquarters.
- e. Interagency, intergovernmental, and nongovernmental organizations.
- Identifies and states the objective or goals of those non-Department of Defense organizations that have a significant role within the assigned area.
 - Refers to Annex V (Interagency Coordination) as required.
- f. Civil considerations. Describes the critical aspects of the civil situation that impact operations (refer to Annex B [Intelligence] as required).
- g. Assumptions. Identifies and lists assumptions used in the development of the OPORD.
4. The staff officer prepares Paragraph 2 - Mission, which provides a short description of the who, what (task), when, where, and why (purpose) that clearly indicates the action to be taken and the reason for doing so.
5. The staff officer prepares Paragraph 3 - Execution, which describes how the commander intends (developed by the commander) to accomplish the mission.
- a. Commander's Intent (Paragraph 3.a.) Describes what the force must do and conditions the force must establish with respect to the enemy, terrain, and civil considerations that represent the desired end state. The commander's intent normally includes:
 - Purpose—an expanded description of the operation's purpose.
 - Key tasks—significant activities the force as a whole must perform to achieve the desired end state.
 - End state—a description of the desired future conditions that represent success.
 - b. Concept of Operations (Paragraph 3.b.) Describes the sequence of actions the force will use to achieve the operation's end state.
 - Uses components of the operational framework (assigned areas, deep, close, and rear operations; and main effort, supporting effort, and reserve) as required.
 - If the concept of operations is phased, describes each phase in a subparagraph. Labels these subparagraphs as "Phase" followed by the appropriate Roman numeral, for example, "Phase I."
 - All paragraphs and subparagraphs of the base order and all attachments must mirror the phasing established in the concept of operations.
 - Refer to Appendix 2 (Operations Overlay) to Annex C (Operations) and other attachments to Annex C (Operations) as required.
 - (1) Scheme of Maneuver (Paragraph 3.b.1.). Describes the employment of maneuver units in accordance with the concept of operations.
 - Identifies the primary tasks of maneuver units (e.g., movement to contact, feint, screen, area defense) and the purpose of each.
 - Identifies and includes priorities for the reserve.
 - Refer to Annex C (Operations) as required.
 - (2) Scheme of Intelligence (Paragraph 3.b.2.). Describes how the commander envisions intelligence supporting the concept of operations.
 - Includes the priority of effort for situation development, targeting, and assessment.
 - States the priority of intelligence support to units and areas.
 - Refers to Annex B (Intelligence) as required.
 - (3) Scheme of Information Collection (Paragraph 3.b.3.). Describes how the commander intends to use reconnaissance missions and surveillance tasks to support the concept of operations.
 - Includes the primary reconnaissance objectives.
 - Refer to Annex L (Information Collection) as required.
- Note: For domestic operations, this paragraph is titled "Information Awareness and Assessment", and the contents of this paragraph comply with Executive Order 12333.
- (4) Scheme of Fires (Paragraph 3.b.4.). Describes how the commander intends to use fires to support the concept of operations.
 - States the priorities for, allocation of, and restrictions on fires.
 - Uses subparagraphs for field artillery support, air support, electromagnetic attack, and offensive cyberspace operations, as required.
 - Refer to Annex C (Operations) and Annex D (Fires) as required.

- (5) Scheme of Protection (Paragraph 3.b.5.). Describes how the commander envisions protection supporting the concept of operations.
 - Includes the priorities of protection by unit and area, including survivability and local security measures.
 - Addresses area security, including security for routes, bases, and critical infrastructure.
 - Identifies reaction forces and their priorities.
 - Uses subparagraphs for protection warfighting (e.g., operational security; chemical, biological, radiological, or nuclear (CBRN) operations; explosive ordnance disposal support; personnel recovery; detention operations; antiterrorism measures; and police operations) as required.
 - Refer to Annex E (Protection) as required.

- (6) Scheme of Engineering (Paragraph 3.b.6.). States the overall scheme of engineering in support of the concept of operations.
 - Describes key mobility, countermobility, survivability, general, and geospatial engineering tasks.
 - Includes priorities of support by unit or area.
 - Refer to Annex G (Engineer) as required.

- (7) Scheme of Air and Missile Defense (Paragraph 3.b.7.). Describes how the commander intends to use air and missile defense to support the concept of operations.
 - States the priorities for, allocation of, and restrictions on air defense artillery (ADA) by phase (This must provide the flexibility necessary for subordinate commanders to determine how to develop their air defense plans while ensuring necessary procedural and positive controls).
 - Includes a general narrative for the entire operation that addresses ADA support tasks, allocation of assets, positioning guidance for ADA units, identification, and engagement authorities (by area, type of aerial threat, or phase of the operation) and rules of engagement (ROE).
 - Refers to Annex C (Operations), Annex D (Fires), and Annex I (Air and Missile Defense) as required.

- c. Tasks to Subordinate Units (Paragraph 3.c.). States the tasks assigned to each unit that reports directly to the headquarters issuing the order. Each task must include who (the subordinate unit assigned the task), what (the task itself), when, where, and why (purpose).
 - Uses a separate subparagraph for each unit.
 - Lists units in task organization sequence.
 - Places tasks that affect two or more units in paragraph 3k (Coordinating Instructions).

- d. Coordinating Instructions (Paragraph 3.d.). Lists only instructions applicable to two or more units not covered in the unit SOP.

- (1) Operational Timeline. List the time or condition when the OPORD becomes effective.
 - Lists critical times.
 - Refers to Appendix 3 (Decision Support Products) to Annex C (Operations) as required.

- (2) Commander's Critical Information Requirements (CCIRs). Lists the CCIRs.
 - Includes subparagraphs for priority intelligence requirements (PIRs).
 - Includes friendly force information requirements (FFIRs).

- (3) Essential Elements of Friendly Information (EEFIs). Lists EEFI.

- (4) Fire Support Coordination Measures. Lists critical fire support coordination or control measures.

- (5) Airspace Coordinating Measures. Lists critical airspace coordinating or control measures.

- (6) Rules of Engagement (ROE).
 - Lists ROE.
 - Refers to Appendix 11 (ROE) to Annex C (Operations) as required.

Note: For operations within the United States and its territories, title this paragraph "Rules for the Use of Force (RUF)."

- (7) Risk Reduction Control Measures. States measures specific to the operation not included in the unit's SOPs.
 - Mission-oriented protective posture (MOPP).
 - Emission control status.
 - Operational exposure guidance.
 - Fratricide avoidance measures.
 - Refers to Annex E (Protection) as required.

- (8) Personnel Recovery Coordination Measures. Personnel recovery measures specific to this operation include:
 - Isolated Soldier guidance.
 - Assigned area-specific legal and ROE considerations as they relate to recovery.
 - Code of Conduct guidance and training requirements.
 - Extracts from the air tasking order special instructions).
 - Refers to Appendix 16 (Personnel Recovery) to Annex C (Operations).

- (9) Themes and messages. Identifies themes and messages to emphasize and those to avoid. Refers to Appendix 13 (Military Information Support Operations [MISO] to Annex C (Operations and Annex J (Public Affairs).

- (10) Other Coordinating Instructions: Lists in subparagraphs any additional coordinating instructions and tasks that apply to two or more units as required.

6. The staff officer prepares Paragraph 4 - Sustainment, which describes the scheme of sustainment, including priorities of sustainment by unit or area, significant sustainment issues that might impact the overall mission, sustainment risks, and unique support requirements.

- Includes instructions for non-tactical movements, deployments, and transportation - or references to applicable appendixes - if appropriate.
- As required, uses the following subparagraphs to provide the scheme of support for logistics, personnel, health service support, and financial management.
- Provides detailed instructions for sustainment subfunctions in appendixes to Annex F (Sustainment).

a. Logistics (Paragraph 4.a.). Provides information on classes of supply.

- Identifies and lists maps, water, special supplies, and excess and salvage materiel, as applicable.
- Lists logistic supply point locations and state logistics plan and procedures.
- Refers to Tab D (Supply) to Appendix 1 (Logistics) to Annex F (Sustainment) as required.

b. Personnel (Paragraph 4.b.). Provides personnel information.

- Outlines plans for unit-strength maintenance; personnel management; morale development and maintenance; discipline, law, and order; headquarters management; force provider; religious support; and legal and finance support.
- Refers to Appendix 2 (Personnel Services Support) to Annex F (Sustainment) as required.

c. Health Service Support (Paragraph 4.c.). Refers to Annex F (Sustainment) as required.

- Provides health service support information.
- Identifies availability, priorities, and instructions for medical treatment from the point of injury through hospitalization at Role 3 and Role 4.
- Describes the plan for collection and medical treatment of sick, injured, or wounded U.S., multinational, and joint force Soldiers; enemy prisoners of war; detainees; and, when authorized, civilians.
- Describes medical evacuation and includes medical regulating and the provision of enroute care for patients being transported.
- Describes support requirements for medical logistics (including blood management), medical device maintenance and services necessary to sustain operations.
- Refers to Appendix 3 (Health Service Support) to Annex F (Sustainment) as required.

d. Financial Management (Paragraph 4.d.). Refers to Annex F (Sustainment) as required.

- Provides financial management support information.
- Identifies financial management support funding responsibilities, command responsibilities, and functional alignments for providing financial management support.
- Ensures sufficient detail to ensure that provisions are made to support all mission essential tasks.
- Outlines special program funding and procedures unique to the operations (e.g., the Commander's Emergency Response Program [CERP], Department of Defense [DOD] Small Rewards Program, and Train and Equip programs).
- Refers to Tab B (Financial Management) to Appendix 2 (Personnel Services Support) to Annex F (Sustainment) as required.

7. The staff officer prepares Paragraph 5 - Command and Signal.

a. Command.

(1) Location of Commander and Key Leaders. States where the commander and key leaders intend to be during the operation, by phase if the operation is phased.

(2) Succession of Command. States the succession of command if not covered in the unit's SOPs.

b. Command Posts.

(1) Describes the employment of command posts (CP), including the location of each CP and the time when it is operational and non-operational, as appropriate.

(2) States the primary controlling CP for specific tasks or phases of the operation (e.g., "The division tactical CP will control the air assault").

c. Signal:

(1) Describes the concept of signal support, including location and movement of key signal nodes and critical electromagnetic spectrum considerations throughout the operation.

(2) States the primary, alternate, contingency, and emergency (PACE) communication plan.

(3) Refers to Annex H (Signal) as required.

8. The staff officer provides instructions for the "ACKNOWLEDGE" section of the OPORD.

- Provides instructions for how the addressees acknowledge receipt of the OPORD (e.g., The word "acknowledge" may suffice).
- Refers to the message reference number if necessary.
- Includes the statement "Acknowledgement of an OPLAN or OPORD means that it has been received and understood".

Note: Acknowledgement of an OPORD means that it has been received and understood.

9. The staff officer requests the commander or authorized representative to sign the original copy. If the representative signs the original, add the phrase "For the Commander". The signed copy is the historical copy and remains in the headquarters' files.

Note: If the commander does not sign, the signature of the preparing staff officer requires authentication. Only the last name and rank of the commander appear in the signature block.

10. The staff officer lists the OPORD's annexes by letter and title (When an attachment is not required, label it "Omitted.").

- Annex A—Task Organization
- Annex B—Intelligence
- Annex C—Operations
- Annex D—Fires
- Annex E—Protection
- Annex F—Sustainment
- Annex G—Engineer
- Annex H—Signal
- Annex I—Air and Missile Defense
- Annex J—Public Affairs
- Annex K—Civil Affairs Operations
- Annex L—Information Collection
- Annex M—Assessment
- Annex N—Space Operations
- Annex O—Spare
- Annex P—Host-Nation Support
- Annex Q—Knowledge Management
- Annex R—Reports
- Annex S—Special Technical Operations
- Annex T—Spare
- Annex U—Inspector General
- Annex V—Interagency Coordination
- Annex W—Operational Contract Support
- Annex X—Spare
- Annex Y—Spare
- Annex Z—Distribution

Note: See FM 5-0 for designation of appendixes and tabs. Table D-2 (on pages 211 through 215) lists the attachments (annexes, appendixes, tabs, and exhibits) to the base OPORD and identifies the staff officers responsible for developing each attachment. If a unit does not have a staff officer listed, the unit SOP should designate an alternate.

11. The staff officer publishes the OPORD with the appropriate attachments or changes to attachments (annexes, appendixes, tabs, exhibits) following the commander's approval.

a. Publishes the OPORD with attachments (annexes, appendixes, tabs, exhibits) or changes to attachments (annexes, appendixes, tabs, exhibits) on the SECRET//RELEASABLE (S//REL) network while retaining not releasable to foreign nationals (NOFORN) information on the secret internet protocol router network (SIPRNET) when working with multinational partners.

Note: The staff officer publishes the OPORD after any changes have been made to the OPORD and its attachments.

b. Coordinates for translation of the OPORD and its attachments (annexes, appendixes, tabs, exhibits) for multinational partners.

(Asterisks indicates a leader performance step.)

Evaluation Guidance: Score the Soldier "GO" if all steps are passed. Score the Soldier "NO-GO" if any step is failed. If the Soldier fails any step, show what was done wrong and how to perform the measure correctly.

Evaluation Preparation: Brief the Soldier: Explain expectations to the Soldier by reviewing the task standards. Stress to the Soldier the importance of observing all cautions and warnings to avoid injury to personnel and, if applicable, damage to equipment.

PERFORMANCE MEASURES	GO	NO-GO	N/A
1. The staff officer prepared an OPORD that is clear and concise with the required supporting information (using the Army's OPORD format) from a selected COA.			
2. The staff officer included administrative information when preparing the OPORD.			
3. The staff officer prepared Paragraph 1 - Situation, which described the conditions of the OE that impact operations.			
4. The staff officer prepared Paragraph 2 - Mission, which provided a short description of the who, what (task), when, where, and why (purpose) that clearly indicated the action to be taken and the reason for doing so.			
5. The staff officer prepared Paragraph 3 - Execution, which described how the commander intended (developed by the commander) to accomplish the mission.			
6. The staff officer prepared Paragraph 4 - Sustainment, which described the scheme of sustainment, including priorities of sustainment by unit or area, significant sustainment issues that might impact the overall mission, sustainment risks, and unique support requirements.			
7. The staff officer prepared Paragraph 5 - Command and Signal.			
8. The staff officer provided instructions for the "ACKNOWLEDGE" section of the OPORD.			
9. The staff officer requested the commander or authorized representative to sign the original copy. If the representative signed the original, added the phrase "For the Commander". The signed copy is the historical copy and remained in the headquarters' files.			
10. The staff officer listed the OPORD's annexes by letter and title (When an attachment was not required, labeled it "Omitted.").			
11. The staff officer published the OPORD with the appropriate attachments or changes to attachments (annexes, appendixes, tabs, exhibits) following the commander's approval.			

Supporting Reference(s):

Step Number	Reference ID	Reference Name	Required	Primary	Source Information
	ADP 5-0	The Operations Process	Yes	No	
	FM 5-0	PLANNING AND ORDERS PRODUCTION	Yes	Yes	
	UNIT SOP	Unit / Unit's Standard Operating Procedure SOP	Yes	No	

TADSS :

TADSS ID	Title	Product Type
20-101	Joint Land Component Constructive Training Capability -Multi-Resolution Federation - Standard Configuration	DVC
71-ALOTT	Army Low Overhead Training Toolkit	SIM
71-20	Common Hardware Platform (CHP)	DVC

Equipment Items (LIN): None

Materiel Items (NSN) :

Step ID	NSN	LIN	Title	Qty
	7010-01-515-2065	FJ1009	Computer System, Digital: AN/PYQ-6B	1
	7010-01-443-2309		Computer System, Digital: AN/TYQ-45A	1

Environment: Environmental protection is not just the law but the right thing to do. It is a continual process and starts with deliberate planning. Always be alert to ways to protect our environment during training and missions. In doing so, you will contribute to the sustainment of our training resources while protecting people and the environment from harmful effects. Refer to the current Environmental Considerations manual and the current GTA Environmental-related Risk Assessment card. Refer to GTA 05-08-002 ENVIRONMENTAL-RELATED RISK ASSESSMENT.

Safety: In a training environment, leaders must perform a risk assessment in accordance with current Risk Management Doctrine. Leaders will complete the current Deliberate Risk Assessment Worksheet in accordance with the TRADOC Safety Officer during the planning and completion of each task and sub-task by assessing mission, enemy, terrain and weather, troops and support available-time available and civil considerations, (METT-TC). Note: During MOPP training, leaders must ensure personnel are monitored for potential heat injury. Local policies and procedures must be followed during times of increased heat category in order to avoid heat related injury. Consider the MOPP work/rest cycles and water replacement guidelines IAW current CBRN doctrine. Refer to GTA 05-08-012 INDIVIDUAL SAFETY CARD.

Prerequisite Individual Tasks : None

Supporting Individual Tasks :

Task Number	Title	Proponent	Status
150-C2-5200	Conduct Command Post Operations	150 - Mission Command (Individual)	Approved

Supported Individual Tasks : None

Supported Collective Tasks : None

Knowledges :

Knowledge ID	Knowledge Name
805V-K-0069	Communicate clear instructions to subordinates

Skills :

Skill ID	Skill Name
S0305	Apply leadership tactics

ICTL Data : None